

Ahwon Cho

SENIOR UX / VISUAL DESIGNER

Strategic UX | Visual Design | Design Systems | AI-Assisted Prototyping

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Profile

UX and visual designer with 10+ years of experience across enterprise tools, e-commerce, and consumer products. Leads zero-to-one design work as the sole UI/UX designer on Microsoft's Surface Commercial team, partnering with seven product managers across multiple products. Turns ambiguous ideas and product requirements into clear user flows, high-fidelity interactive prototypes, and implementation-ready specifications. Uses AI-assisted prototyping to explore and communicate product directions quickly.

Core Expertise

Product Design: Zero-to-one design, product strategy, information architecture, user flows, prototyping, usability testing

Visual and Interaction: Visual hierarchy, typography, color, responsive UI, iconography, high-fidelity design

Design Systems: Figma libraries, Auto Layout, variables, reusable components, light and dark themes

Collaboration: Workshop facilitation, product storytelling, presentations, PM and engineering partnership

Design Tools: Figma, Adobe Creative Cloud

Prototyping: AI-assisted functional prototyping, VS Code, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, React

Experience

UI/UX Designer (Contract) | Microsoft

Aug 2023 to Present | Remote

- Own UX and visual design from early concepts through implementation across Surface Commercial products, including Surface Management Portal, Surface Support Portal, Surface Knowledge Portal, and Surface IT Toolkit, partnering with seven product managers.
- Turn ambiguous product requirements and early-stage ideas into user flows, detailed UI, and high-fidelity interactive prototypes, using AI-assisted coding to test directions quickly.
- Facilitate design discussions and workshops with product managers, engineers, and design partners to align teams around a shared direction.
- Adapt Microsoft's design system into local Figma libraries where existing components need modernization, making designs easier to update and collaborate on.
- Review final UI and UX implementations across multiple teams, providing guidance on interaction and visual design.
- Create accessibility design specifications for developers, including keyboard tab order, color contrast requirements, and responsive behavior.

Senior UX Designer (Contract) | The Home Depot

Sep 2022 to Mar 2023 | Atlanta, GA

- Designed the post-purchase protection plan flows for General Merchandise and Major Appliances, covering two entry points and five product scenarios.
- Mapped the full flow after the first design missed appliance and mixed-order scenarios. Revised the drawer with product, engineering, and Allstate partners.
- Prepared the prototype for testing and annotated designs for both the legacy system and Stencil. Received Caught Orange Handed recognition from the design team.

UX Designer (Contract) | Microsoft

Mar 2022 to Aug 2022 | Redmond, WA

- Created wireframes and user flows for a B2B management application with network infrastructure and chatbot features.
- Created design assets and storyboards to explain product concepts and support team discussions.

Visual Interface Designer (Contract) | Blue Cross Blue Shield of North Carolina

Jun 2021 to Mar 2022 | Durham, NC

- Designed wireflows and a high-fidelity prototype for an Advance EOB cost-estimate request in four weeks, revising the flow through stakeholder reviews.
- Redesigned the Blue Connect mobile home screen, exploring three visual directions for task shortcuts, plan navigation, and benefit information.
- Built reusable Figma components and prepared prototypes and visual specifications for web and mobile designs.

Product Designer | Coco N Design | Jun 2020 to Mar 2021

Designed Pantry Note from research and sketches through interactive Figma prototypes, including the first-use flow for adding food items.

UX/UI Designer | SM Beauty | Aug 2017 to Sep 2018 | Illinois

Designed an e-commerce website and warehouse-management application using customer interviews and product feedback to develop the flows and UI.

UX/Visual Designer | SamsBeauty | Aug 2016 to Jan 2017 | Illinois

Redesigned an e-commerce site using customer and coworker feedback. Worked on user flows, visual consistency, and B2B and B2C web and mobile interfaces.

UX/Visual Designer | Independent Clients | Jan 2014 to May 2016 | South Korea

Designed mobile apps and responsive websites. Worked with developers and built interfaces using HTML, CSS, and Bootstrap.

Visual and Motion Designer | SK M&S, Chai Communications, CNR M&C | Jul 2008 to Jun 2011 | South Korea

Created web designs, motion assets, and promotional sites for clients including Samsung Electronics and BC Card. Built pages using CMS tools.

Project

GPU Flight | Offleash Lab | 2026 | In progress

Lead zero-to-one UX and visual design for a GPU performance dashboard, turning early technical concepts into functional React and TypeScript prototypes with AI-assisted coding in VS Code. Build the frontend in partnership with a software engineer.

- Created Verdant 2, a design system with shared style tokens, light and dark themes, component documentation, and page templates.

Education

Maryland Institute College of Art | Master's in UX Design | 2019 to 2020

Korea National Open University | BA in Media Arts and Sciences | 2009 to 2011

Languages

Korean (native) | English (fluent)